



TiVo

TiVo to the western world is what DVR or Digital Video

Recording is to the rest of us. In existence for little over a decade now, TiVo was the first device launched that could record cable television content on a hard disk rather than magnetic tape or VHS.

TiVo also introduced the world to TV guides, or on-screen programme information, much to the joy of couch potatoes the world over. The product became iconic and soon added words to the English lexicon such as "TiVo'ed" which meant to record any TV show. TiVo or it's modern day avatars, the DVRs have very recently hit our shores but are catching on quickly.



Bose, Amar

Yes we know Audiophiles (refer to A) reading this would turn up their noses, but that doesn't take away the contribution of



Amar Bose to the field of Psychoacoustics and of course the fact that he is one of the richest people in the world. He was elected a Fellow of IEEE, 1972 - for contributions to loudspeaker design, two-state amplifier-modulators, and nonlinear systems. The company he founded in 1964 Bose Corporation, is well known even in non-audio enthusiasts circles. It may not provide the best value for money offerings but hey it forms an important part of home entertainment. More so also because of the unique space saving design.

332,000 kg

The weight of the world's largest HD TV currently in operation. Set up on the Charlotte Motor Speedway somewhere in America, this TV measures a whopping 200ft by 80ft.



Universal remotes

If any device has had the maximum contribution to laziness at home, it has to be the remote. This innocuous little clicker lets the pro-convenience user sit back, relax and comfortably add on a couple of pounds while surfing his favourite channels. Over the years, the remote has evolved quite a bit. From controlling only one



device they expanded their reach to many peripherals. Some years ago Logitech and Philips came out with really fancy remotes from the Harmony and Control Panel series respectively. These things had three figure dollar prices, and came with touch screens. The most recent generation of remotes sport Qwerty keyboards to pair with web-capable Smart TVs and HD Media Players. What's next? Thought controlled remote implants? Maybe.



DLNA

Digital Living Network Alliance is simply a

standard for which devices can be certified. Such DLNA certified devices can easily communicate with each other on a home network. Devices range from TVs, AV Receivers, Home Theaters, Network Storage Drives, Cameras, Gaming Con-



soles, to even Printers. All these devices can share media with each other. You can play a movie from your NAS box on your HD Screen, upload or print photos from your camera and basically have digital media accessible from anywhere to any device.



CES 2010

At Consumer Electronics Show, held every year at

Las Vegas, the stars of the technology world announce cutting edge innovations to spellbound audiences. The show sees several "world firsts" and has always been dazzling visitors right from its debut in 1967. But one edition from recent years that stood

apart was CES 2010. Hailed as the year of 3D, the show saw several innovative products from the likes of Samsung, LG and Sony. But Intel and Alioscopy showcased screens that stole the show - 3D displays that don't need those dorky glasses - Autostereoscopic displays. We also saw several small products such as the AR Drone that added their own unique flavour to the cutting-edge melange.



Audiophile

An Audiophile is someone who takes his audio

seriously; way too seriously! They are an arcane lot who'll survive on instant noodles for a whole year if they have to, just so that they can invest in that high-end difficult to procure piece of audio equipment which costs the equivalent of a kidney on the black market. While most of us would be happy with high quality cables, these guys sell an arm and leg to get gold wires. Jokes apart if we were to define Audiophiles, they are a community of enthusiasts who are constantly engaged in improving audio reproduction at home by investing in equipment and software that will enhance their aural experience. Can usually be spotted using words like "lush, sparkly, bright, sonorous texture, wide soundstage" to describe audio.



Plasma Speakers

Speaker diaphragms are supposed to be extremely light, and they can't get lighter than this. Plasma speakers are massless speakers which use plasma arcs to heat the air and produce changes in air-pressure and hence, sound. Of course, you would require a high voltage source and Helium, not to mention that the Ozone gas produced is actually poisonous and can kill you. At \$23,000 for a high quality driver, this is a very expensive way of committing suicide. But, who cares? In the quest for audio nirvana certain sacrifices have to be made. Check out the video at: <http://bit.ly/FcsGS>